Door

From the mosque of Aytmish al-Bagasi

Burji Mamluk, 784-85 AH / 1383 CE

Wood, Ivory

W: 100 cm; H: 196 cm

Hall 4

Inv. no. 2605



Door leaves recovered from the mosque of Amir Aytmish al-Bagasi (784-85 AH / 1383 CE), decorated with a prominent geometric star pattern based on twelve-pointed stars with wood and ivory joinery pieces. The door represents a rare surviving example of the mosque's original wooden fittings; the interior is relatively plain at present, with many doors, windows, and the minbar replaced by simpler modern

substitutes. Traces of painted decoration on the ceiling of the eastern (qibla) iwan hint at the mosque's former richness, diminished both by disruptions following Amir Aytmish's death - after a career that saw him serve as amir under Sultan Barquq, then as regent for Barquq's son Farag, before fleeing to Damascus and ultimately being killed by Yalbugha al-Nasiri - as well as through later flooding and the natural ravages of time.

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